

VOLTR

VOLTR PROGRAM

3-Day Minimum

8 weeks · 3 full-body sessions per week · 45 minutes · gym
or hotel

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How this program works

THE PLAN

Three full-body sessions a week, 45 minutes each, for eight weeks. Built for the weeks when the calendar is full: heavy work periods, frequent travel, family commitments. A small set of compound exercises, done hard, with fixed rest and nothing else.

Every exercise has a hotel-gym version with dumbbells. In a hotel the structure stays the same; those sessions hold your progress rather than build it.

WHO IT IS FOR

Trained adults, at least one year of consistent lifting, whose time is limited by work and travel. You want to keep building strength and muscle on three sessions a week and you need a plan that works on the road with no adjustment.

WHO IT IS NOT FOR

Beginners who still need coaching on the basic lifts.

Anyone with a current injury, or a medical condition that has not been cleared for hard training.

Anyone with three 75-minute slots a week and a full gym: Athletic Strength or Hybrid fit better.

EQUIPMENT

Main version: barbell and rack, bench, trap bar, dumbbells, cable station, landmine, pull-up bar.

Hotel version: dumbbells, an adjustable bench if available, a pull-up bar or a door anchor band if available.

THE WEEK

Any three days with at least one day off between two of them. Monday, Wednesday, Friday works. So does Tuesday, Thursday, Saturday. In travel weeks the days can move, the order 1, 2, 3 stays.

THE 45 MINUTES

Warm-up: 8 minutes.

Pair 1 (the two main lifts): about 13 minutes.

Pair 2: about 11 minutes.

Pair 3 (trunk and carry or conditioning): about 8 minutes.

Rest is fixed. Use a timer. At minute 45 the session ends, even if something is left. The time limit is part of the plan. Work faster next time by keeping the rest exact.

HOW TO READ THE SHEET

The spreadsheet has the tabs START HERE (this page), PROGRAM (weeks 1 to 8), LOG.

The PROGRAM tab shows the three days as rows and the eight weeks as column groups. Each week has two columns: the target and an empty Load column for you.

Target format: sets x reps @ RIR. 3 × 6-8 @ RIR 2 means three sets of six to eight reps, each set ending with two reps in reserve. /side means each arm or leg.

Exercises are done in pairs: one set of 1a, rest as listed on the 1a line, one set of 1b, rest as listed on the 1b line, repeat for all sets. Then pair 2, then pair 3.

Hotel / DB alternative: use it when the equipment is missing. Take hotel sets to RIR 0 to 1, up to about 30 reps: light weights still work when the set is hard.

Write H in front of the load, for example H 2 × 24, and do not use H sets to progress your barbell loads.

RIR AND RPE

RIR means reps in reserve: how many more clean reps you could have done when you end the set. RPE is the same scale counted the other way: RPE 8 equals RIR 2, RPE 9 equals RIR 1.

Choose the load from the target RIR. Most people underestimate what was left by about one rep, more on higher-rep sets. If the last rep moved as fast as the first, add load next time.

PROGRESSION

Double progression on every lift. Each exercise has a rep range, for example 6 to 8. Use one load for all sets. When every set reaches the top of the range at the target RIR, add the smallest load step next session (2.5 to 5 kg on a barbell, 1 to 2 kg per dumbbell) and start again at the bottom of the range.

Weeks 1 to 3: RIR 3 to 2. Find the right loads.

Week 4: pivot week. Same exercises, two sets each, RIR 3. About 30 minutes. Fatigue drops before the harder half.

Weeks 5 to 7: RIR 2 to 1, and the main pair gets a fourth set. Week 8 drops back to three sets so the benchmarks are tested fresh.

After week 8: one pivot week like week 4, then start again at week 1 with your new loads.

Hotel dumbbells too light: more reps, up to about 30, every set to RIR 0 to 1. Log it with H.

WARM-UP

8 minutes, no more.

1. 2 minutes: bike, rower, or jumping jacks and high knees in the hotel room.
2. World's greatest stretch x 3 per side and band pull-apart or wall slide x 12.
3. Ramp-up on the first lift of the day: two or three sets with falling reps, climbing towards the working load.

MISSED SESSIONS AND
BAD WEEKS

Missed a session: do the next one in order.

Only two sessions this week: do 1 and 2. Next week starts with 3.

A full week lost to work or travel: repeat the last week you completed.

Bad day: sets and reps stay as written, the load follows the target RIR. Log it.

Only 25 minutes: warm-up, pair 1 with all sets, then the carry. End there.

HOW TO LOG

Write the load in kg into the Load cell after the last working set. Different loads per set: 100, 102.5, 102.5. Reps short of the target: 100×5 , 5, 4.

Fill in the LOG tab once a week, and the benchmarks in week 1 and week 8.

The log decides next week's load.

Weeks 1 to 8 · 3 full-body sessions · 45 minutes

Three full-body sessions, same exercises for eight weeks, so every week can be compared with the last. Exercises run in pairs: 1a, 1b, rest, repeat. Double progression: when all sets reach the top of the rep range at the target RIR, add load. Week 4 is the pivot week, two sets per exercise and about 30 minutes. From week 5 the main pair gets a fourth set and RIR drops to 1 to 2. Week 8 goes back to three sets for a fresh test. No equipment for an exercise: use the hotel / DB column and mark the load with H.

Day 1 · Squat + Push

Squat, horizontal press, vertical pull, hinge, anti-rotation, carry.

1a Back squat

Brace before you unrack. Sit down between the heels, chest and hips rise together.

REST 60 S

Hotel / DB: Rear-foot-elevated split squat with DBs, each set to RIR 0-1

WK 1 · SET LOADS

3 × 5-8 @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD

3 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · PIVOT

2 × 5 @ RIR 3

WK 5 · PROGRESS

4 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · PROGRESS

4 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PROGRESS

4 × 5-8 @ RIR 1

WK 8 · TEST

3 × 5-8 @ RIR 1

1b Chin-up

Full hang to chin over the bar, no swing. Add load once all sets reach 8.

REST 90 S

Hotel / DB: Pull-up on any bar. No bar: single-arm DB row, 2 s pause at the top

WK 1 · SET LOADS

3 × 5-8 @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD

3 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · PIVOT

2 × 5 @ RIR 3

WK 5 · PROGRESS

4 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · PROGRESS

4 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 7 · PROGRESS

4 × 5-8 @ RIR 1

WK 8 · TEST

3 × 5-8 @ RIR 1

2a Bench press

Shoulder blades together, feet planted. Touch the lower chest, press.

REST 60 S

Hotel / DB: DB bench press. No bench: DB floor press

WK 1 · SET LOADS

3 × 6-10 @ RIR 3

WK 2 · BUILD

3 × 6-10 @ RIR 2

WK 3 · BUILD

3 × 6-10 @ RIR 2

WK 4 · PIVOT

2 × 6 @ RIR 3

WK 5 · PROGRESS

3 × 6-10 @ RIR 2

WK 6 · PROGRESS

3 × 6-10 @ RIR 1-2

WK 7 · PROGRESS

3 × 6-10 @ RIR 1

WK 8 · TEST

3 × 6-10 @ RIR 1

2b Romanian deadlift

Soft knees, hips back, weight close to the legs. Stop before the back rounds.

REST 90 S

Hotel / DB: DB Romanian deadlift, each set to RIR 0-1

WK 1 • SET LOADS
3 × 8-10 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 8-10 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 8-10 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • PIVOT
2 × 8 @ RIR 3

WK 5 • PROGRESS
3 × 8-10 @ RIR 2

WK 6 • PROGRESS
3 × 8-10 @ RIR 1-2

WK 7 • PROGRESS
3 × 8-10 @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST
3 × 8-10 @ RIR 1

3a Pallof press

Side-on to the cable, press out, hold 3 s. The torso does not turn.

REST 0 S

Hotel / DB: Band Pallof press. No band: dead bug, 6/side

WK 1 • SET LOADS
3 × 10/side

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 10/side

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 10/side

WK 4 • PIVOT
2 × 10/side

WK 5 • PROGRESS
3 × 10/side

WK 6 • PROGRESS
3 × 10/side

WK 7 • PROGRESS
3 × 10/side

WK 8 • TEST
3 × 10/side

3b Farmer carry

Heaviest load you can carry with good posture. Short, quick steps.

REST 60 S

Hotel / DB: DB farmer carry with the heaviest pair. Corridor or car park

WK 1 • SET LOADS
3 × 30 m

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 30 m

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 30 m

WK 4 • PIVOT
2 × 30 m

WK 5 • PROGRESS
3 × 30 m

WK 6 • PROGRESS
3 × 30 m

WK 7 • PROGRESS
3 × 30 m

WK 8 • TEST
3 × 30 m

Day 2 • Hinge + Pull

Deadlift, vertical press, single leg, horizontal pull, lateral trunk, carry.

1a Trap bar deadlift

Push the floor away, stand tall, lower under control. Reset each rep.

REST 60 S

Hotel / DB: DB deadlift from the floor with the heaviest pair. Light DBs: DB single-leg RDL

WK 1 • SET LOADS
3 × 4-6 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 4-6 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 4-6 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • PIVOT
2 × 4 @ RIR 3

WK 5 • PROGRESS
4 × 4-6 @ RIR 2

WK 6 • PROGRESS
4 × 4-6 @ RIR 2

WK 7 • PROGRESS
4 × 4-6 @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST
3 × 4-6 @ RIR 1

1b Half-kneeling landmine press

Down on the knee of the pressing side. Squeeze that glute, ribs stay down.

REST 90 S

Hotel / DB: Half-kneeling single-arm DB press

WK 1 • SET LOADS

3 × 6-8/side @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD

3 × 6-8/side @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD

3 × 6-8/side @ RIR 2

WK 4 • PIVOT

2 × 6/side @ RIR 3

WK 5 • PROGRESS

4 × 6-8/side @ RIR 2

WK 6 • PROGRESS

4 × 6-8/side @ RIR 2

WK 7 • PROGRESS

4 × 6-8/side @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST

3 × 6-8/side @ RIR 1

2a Bulgarian split squat

Front shin close to vertical at the bottom. Start with the weaker leg.

REST 60 S

Hotel / DB: Same with DBs. Rear foot on a bench, chair or bed frame

WK 1 • SET LOADS

3 × 8-10/side @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD

3 × 8-10/side @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD

3 × 8-10/side @ RIR 2

WK 4 • PIVOT

2 × 8/side @ RIR 3

WK 5 • PROGRESS

3 × 8-10/side @ RIR 2

WK 6 • PROGRESS

3 × 8-10/side @ RIR 1-2

WK 7 • PROGRESS

3 × 8-10/side @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST

3 × 8-10/side @ RIR 1

2b Chest-supported DB row

Elbows towards the hips, pause at the top, lower all the way.

REST 90 S

Hotel / DB: Same on any incline bench, or one-arm DB row on a chair

WK 1 • SET LOADS

3 × 8-12 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD

3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD

3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • PIVOT

2 × 8 @ RIR 3

WK 5 • PROGRESS

3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 6 • PROGRESS

3 × 8-12 @ RIR 1-2

WK 7 • PROGRESS

3 × 8-12 @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST

3 × 8-12 @ RIR 1

3a Side plank

Elbow under the shoulder, hips forward, one line from head to feet.

REST 0 S

Hotel / DB: Same

WK 1 • SET LOADS

3 × 30 s/side

WK 2 • BUILD

3 × 30 s/side

WK 3 • BUILD

3 × 30 s/side

WK 4 • PIVOT

2 × 30 s/side

WK 5 • PROGRESS

3 × 30 s/side

WK 6 • PROGRESS

3 × 30 s/side

WK 7 • PROGRESS

3 × 30 s/side

WK 8 • TEST

3 × 30 s/side

3b Suitcase carry

One heavy weight in one hand. Shoulders level, walk tall.

REST 60 S

Hotel / DB: Same with one DB

WK 1 • SET LOADS
3 × 30 m/side

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 30 m/side

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 30 m/side

WK 4 • PIVOT
2 × 30 m/side

WK 5 • PROGRESS
3 × 30 m/side

WK 6 • PROGRESS
3 × 30 m/side

WK 7 • PROGRESS
3 × 30 m/side

WK 8 • TEST
3 × 30 m/side

Day 3 • Full Body

Front squat, vertical pull, incline press, hip extension, conditioning.

1a Front squat

Elbows high, upright torso. Sit straight down.

REST 60 S

Hotel / DB: DB reverse lunge, DBs held at the shoulders

WK 1 • SET LOADS
3 × 5-8 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • PIVOT
2 × 5 @ RIR 3

WK 5 • PROGRESS
4 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 6 • PROGRESS
4 × 5-8 @ RIR 2

WK 7 • PROGRESS
4 × 5-8 @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST
3 × 5-8 @ RIR 1

1b Neutral-grip pull-up or lat pulldown

Pull to the upper chest, elbows down. Control the way up.

REST 90 S

Hotel / DB: Single-arm DB row, 2 s pause at the top

WK 1 • SET LOADS
3 × 6-10 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 6-10 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 6-10 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • PIVOT
2 × 6 @ RIR 3

WK 5 • PROGRESS
4 × 6-10 @ RIR 2

WK 6 • PROGRESS
4 × 6-10 @ RIR 2

WK 7 • PROGRESS
4 × 6-10 @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST
3 × 6-10 @ RIR 1

2a Incline DB press

Bench at 30 degrees. Elbows about 45 degrees from the body.

REST 60 S

Hotel / DB: Same on an adjustable bench. No bench: feet-elevated push-up to RIR 0-1

WK 1 • SET LOADS
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • PIVOT
2 × 8 @ RIR 3

WK 5 • PROGRESS
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 6 • PROGRESS
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 1-2

WK 7 • PROGRESS
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 1

2b Barbell hip thrust

Upper back on the bench, chin tucked. Squeeze at the top for 1 s.

REST 90 S

Hotel / DB: Single-leg hip thrust, back on the bed edge or a bench, DB on the hip

WK 1 • SET LOADS
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 3

WK 2 • BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 3 • BUILD
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 4 • PIVOT
2 × 8 @ RIR 3

WK 5 • PROGRESS
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 2

WK 6 • PROGRESS
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 1-2

WK 7 • PROGRESS
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 1

WK 8 • TEST
3 × 8-12 @ RIR 1

3 Conditioning intervals

Bike, rower or sled. 30 s hard, 30 s easy. Hard means RPE 8 to 9, the same output on every round.

Hotel / DB: DB thrusters or burpees, same intervals

WK 1 • SET LOADS
6 rounds 30 s / 30 s

WK 2 • BUILD
6 rounds 30 s / 30 s

WK 3 • BUILD
7 rounds 30 s / 30 s

WK 4 • PIVOT
4 rounds 30 s / 30 s

WK 5 • PROGRESS
8 rounds 30 s / 30 s

WK 6 • PROGRESS
8 rounds 30 s / 30 s

WK 7 • PROGRESS
8 rounds 30 s / 30 s

WK 8 • TEST
8 rounds 30 s / 30 s

V O L T R

NEXT STEP

Want it built around your weeks?

This program is written for most weeks. 1:1 coaching builds your training around your schedule, travel and history, and adjusts it every week.

Book a free 30-minute call: voltr.at/#book